



PROGRESS REPORT

Eswatini: progress report, September 2025 – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-10 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-09-01 to 2026-09-10.

Progress values. *Movement* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	A digital readiness assessment published in November 2024 places the country at the systematic stage across all six of its pillars. The assessment was launched by the ICT ministry with a development agency in November 2024 and places the country at the systematic stage across digital public infrastructure, connectivity, government, regulation, economy and people (assessment). It finds that a national digital strategy is in place but that digitalisation holds only moderate political support, naming limited political prioritisation and coordination as the constraint on the government pillar (finding). The strategy the assessment refers to is not itself held, and no implementation plan or budget against the assessment's recommendations is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The national ICT policy dates from 2006 and the ICT ministry's own 2024/25 report to Parliament still runs against it. The 2006 policy, adopted by Cabinet that August, is the identifiable national ICT policy; an implementation plan was drafted for 2012 to 2016 and no replacement is held (policy). What is moving is financing and legislation rather than strategy. A World Bank grant of US\$2 million funds eighteen months of preparation for the Digital Eswatini project, including a consultancy to write a digital roadmap and implementation plan (procurement plan). The Senate moved in February 2026 to take the Critical Infrastructure Protection Bill at the stage it had reached in the preceding session, sponsored by the ICT minister (order paper). Neither produces a strategy: the roadmap is a consultancy not yet let, and the Bill is not an Act.	NO CHANGE a policy of 2006 still named as the governing framework
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	The regulator's universal access strategy for 2018-2021 is the only broadband instrument held, and it awaited a National Broadband Plan that never arrives on this base. The strategy states that national broadband targets awaited a separate National Broadband Plan and Strategy, and substituted SADC targets in the meantime; its period expired in 2021 and no renewal is held (strategy). The regulator moved on the baseline instead. It proposed on 16 July 2026 to raise the minimum guaranteed internet speed from 2 Mbps to 10 Mbps, open for comment to 18 August 2026 (notice). The 2 Mbps target it would replace has stood in the quality-of-service regulations since 2016. What the base holds is regulation without a plan behind it: a proposed speed floor, a national backbone under rollout, and no published national broadband target at any date.	NO CHANGE the one broadband strategy expired in 2021 with no renewal held
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A draft national data governance policy for 2027-2031 was validated in July 2026, and a cloud memorandum with a hyperscaler is in force. The draft policy was validated in July 2026 and is targeted for completion before the end of the year; it proposes a tell-government-once principle under which a citizen supplies information once and authorised institutions reach it when delivering a service (validation). The consultancy funded to write the Digital Eswatini roadmap is scoped to cover cloud solutions and a data-migration operating model (procurement plan). A memorandum with a hyperscaler is established as a cloud-services and electronic-government arrangement, and the national data centre operates and is named a structural concentration of state information. No hosting policy, cloud-first rule or data-residency instrument for government systems is held; the closest is the data protection authority's directive that controllers record where their data is stored.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	A national data exchange platform is proposed in the draft data governance policy; no interoperability framework document is held. Mchumanisi is proposed as the platform through which authorised institutions would reach information a citizen supplies once, with birth and marriage certificate services named among the intended uses; no specification, procurement or timetable is held (proposal). The ICT ministry's report to Parliament for 2024/25 records GovStack-model application development and a review of the electronic-government interoperability framework (report). The World Bank consultancy funded to write the digital roadmap is scoped to include data interoperability as a public-infrastructure building block (procurement plan). Against all of that, more than half of ministries lack meaningful system interoperability on the base's own measure. The framework is reviewed, funded and proposed, and not published.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	No national artificial-intelligence strategy or statute is held, and two instruments now carry artificial-intelligence rules while neither is an artificial-intelligence instrument. The finding is stated in coverage of the online media guidelines: rules on the technology are arriving inside instruments written for something else (absence). A national fourth-industrial-revolution strategy framed the prime minister's address to a global artificial-intelligence governance dialogue in Geneva (strategy), so the country argues a position internationally on the strength of an instrument that is not about artificial intelligence either.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies	No localisation policy is held. The Data Protection Act governs transborder flow, and a 2025 directive makes controllers record where data is stored. The Act's Part V governs the transborder flow of personal information and is the closest instrument to a localisation rule; the base holds no standalone localisation policy (Act). The data protection authority directed in September 2025 that every controller and processor, public bodies included, map and inventory its data — flows, storage location and sharing — with returns due by 31 March 2026 (directive). At the opening of the national data policy workshop on 29 April 2026 the ICT minister said the policy aims to make Eswatini one of the safest places in the world to store data (workshop). A stated ambition to attract storage is not a residency rule, and no compliance count for the mapping directive is held.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A National Data Governance Policy is targeted for completion before end-2026, with government undecided between a standalone law and amendments to existing legislation. A first national workshop ran in April 2026 and the policy was validated in July, on a procurement issued through a continental alliance in 2025 (validation, workshop, procurement). The minister told the Senate the completion target and stated that government has not decided between a standalone data-governance law and amendments to what exists; the target was put as aspirational in debate rather than as a statutory deadline (senate). That undecided question matters more than the date: the country already has a data protection Act, so whether data governance sits inside it or beside it decides which authority enforces what.	MOVEMENT

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Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy	No open data policy or portal is held. The draft data governance policy is about sharing between institutions rather than publication to the public. The draft policy for 2027 to 2031 was validated in July 2026 and turns on institutions reaching each other's records, not on publishing them (validation). The drafting process opened in April 2026 with European Union, member state and GIZ support under a data governance initiative (workshop). The data-mapping directive creates the inventories a publication regime would need, distinguishing what is held from what is protected (directive). What the base does not hold: a national open-data portal, a publication licence, a list of datasets any public body is obliged to release, or a date by which any of that is due.	NO CHANGE a data governance policy in draft and no open-data instrument
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2022 has been effective since March 2022, and its gazetted text names a Commission while the regulator describes itself as the designated Agency. The Act was gazetted and took effect on 4 March 2022. The mismatch between the body the statute names and the body describing itself as designated is recorded rather than resolved (Act). The Act is being read in press accounts as exposing online naming and shaming to a substantial penalty; that is an account of legal exposure rather than an enforcement action, and no complaint, ruling or authority statement is held (exposure). A statute whose enforcing body is ambiguous on the face of the record is a limit on everything the protection cells below can say.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Cybersecurity, critical infrastructure, e-commerce and artificial-intelligence legislation was named as forthcoming alongside the capital's smart-city deployment. The communications regulator publicly stated that cyberbullying is a criminal offence under the computer crime statute (statement). No prosecution or complaint figure is on the base. Four instruments were named together in August 2025 (legislation). None has entered the base since as a draft, a tabling or an enactment. Naming a legislative programme alongside a deployment of 59 camera systems and a fifth-generation network is the sequence worth recording: the deployment is in progress and the four laws that would govern it are a list.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	Identity rests on the Identification Order of 1998; no digital identity Act exists, and three conventions went to senators for ratification in July 2026. The King's Order in Council of 1998 establishes the population register and the personal identity number, and is the founding legal instrument behind national identity; no dedicated digital-identity Act is held (Order). The ICT minister presented the African Union Malabo Convention on cyber security and personal data protection, the Budapest Convention on cybercrime and the Tampere Convention to senators for ratification on 10 July 2026 (workshop). SADC ICT ministers had urged member states to consider ratifying Malabo in September 2019 (ministerial). Seven years later it is at the presentation stage. The digital identity itself remains planned under the Digital Eswatini project, with no legal basis on file for it.	MOVEMENT on treaty ratification rather than on any identity statute

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Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The National Payments System Act 2023 is in force, regulations to operationalise it were approved by Cabinet in July 2026, and the fast-payments platform completed onboarding in November 2025. The Act of 2023 provides for the regulation and supervision of payment systems, the safety and efficiency of the national payments system and the central bank's functions in relation to them (Act). Cabinet approved National Payment Systems Regulations of 2026 in the first quarter of 2026/27 to operationalise it; no gazette text, publication or commencement date is held (Cabinet). The central bank governor told a regional report launch on 13 November 2025 that the eighth and final participant would go live on the fast-payments platform two days later (remarks). The statute is the enablement and the switch is the delivery; the regulations between them are approved and unpublished.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No Act enables data interoperability. The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act is the nearest instrument, and it does not create a duty to share. The Act of 2022 is the operative electronic-transactions statute and the closest legal basis for exchange between public bodies; nothing in the base creates an interoperability obligation (Act). The obligations that do exist run the other way. The data protection authority requires every controller to document its data flows, storage and sharing, which constrains exchange rather than mandating it (directive). Where systems are being joined it is by project rather than statute: the 2026 budget speech reports the first release of an integrated financial management information system (budget speech). More than half of ministries still lack meaningful system interoperability.	NO CHANGE no interoperability statute and the duties that exist are protective
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations	No AI Act or regulation exists. The regulator's spectrum guidelines are the only binding instrument touching AI devices, and a national AI strategy is not held. The 2024 licence-exempt spectrum guidelines are the base's only binding instrument expressly touching artificial-intelligence and internet-of-things devices (guidelines). A reviewed science, technology and innovation policy and a combined fourth and fifth industrial revolution strategy went to stakeholder validation in February 2026, framing artificial intelligence, automation and data governance inside a human-centred approach; neither document is held (validation). The Prime Minister told a global governance dialogue in July 2026, speaking for the King, that artificial-intelligence governance frameworks should protect children and uphold human dignity (Geneva). The regulator has issued guidance on artificial intelligence and deepfakes in broadcasting, which is guidance and not an instrument with force. A national AI strategy was probed and not found.	NO CHANGE no artificial-intelligence instrument and a strategy that is Not held

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026 are stated by the ministry as complete in development, and restrictions on children reaching harmful content were raised in the Senate with no instrument behind them. The ministry stated development of the guidelines is complete, and used the same account to state that implementation, enforcement and oversight of data protection are vested in the regulator rather than itself (guidelines). A senator asked during a Senate debate what prevents minors reaching harmful content; the answer was that two offices are working together on online-content regulation. No instrument, timetable, age-verification method or definition of harmful content is stated, and no draft is held (question). Guidelines complete but unpublished, and content regulation that exists only as an answer in debate, are the two forms this unit's regulation of platforms takes.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation	The Statistics Act of 1967 is the operative statute, fifty-nine years old and unamended on the base, with no replacement Bill held. The Act constitutes the Central Statistical Office and carries its collection powers; no amendment, replacement Bill or commencement is held (Act). Under it, the ministry and the population fund launched the 2027 Population and Housing Census together with the 2025/2026 Economic Census in November 2025 (launch). The 2026 budget speech reports household mapping and listing begun and E130.5 million allocated (budget speech). The gap is the point: the largest statistical operation in a decade runs on a statute written before the internet, and nothing on the base sets a date for replacing it.	NO CHANGE a statute of 1967 unamended against a census it must now carry
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	No access to information law exists. The ICT ministry's own report to Parliament lists developing a Bill as a departmental action-plan item. The ministry's annual performance report for 2024/25 lists 'Develop Access to Information Bill' among its departmental action-plan items; the Bill is not tabled and no text or timetable is held (report). A regional media-freedom body met the ministry's principal secretary on 25 February 2026 and said it was on standby to support enactment; the ministry reaffirmed cooperation on media self-regulation and made no enactment commitment (communique). Where the ministry has legislated on information it has legislated on publishing rather than access: online media publishing guidelines are complete on its own account. Without an access right, the data governance policy's sharing between institutions has no counterpart obliging disclosure to a citizen.	NO CHANGE a Bill named as an action-plan item and not tabled

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Data protection	Data protection authority	The authority opened its first major investigation, into a ministry that published unblurred national identity documents and missed the 72-hour breach-notification duty. The investigation was opened in June 2026, following an awareness campaign in February and a lender assessment naming digital transformation as key to growth (investigation, campaign, assessment). The breach was the ministry's own publication of unblurred identity documents, and it missed the statutory 72-hour notification (breach). The ICT ministry stated on the record that implementation, enforcement and oversight are vested in the regulator and not in itself, which settles the mandate question in practice even as the statute's naming of the body remains unresolved (mandate). A first investigation opening against a government ministry, rather than a private controller, is the strongest single fact about this authority in the record. The authority has used its powers: three enforcement notices under section 41 of the Act are published, two in June 2024 against a mobile operator and an insurer and one in March 2025 against the science and technology park. No register of complaints, breach notifications or registered controllers accompanies them.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	National data protection readiness	Advisory guidelines on health data went to validation workshops, sector guidelines were validated over a week, and biometric gate passes were deployed in schools without ministry approval. Health-data guidelines opened validation workshops in July 2026 (health), and sector guidelines were validated at a week-long workshop in August; no breach count, penalty or enforcement action is published behind the regulator's ranking, and the draft guidelines are not held (sector). Some public schools deployed biometric gate passes without education ministry approval, charging about E200 per pupil (schools). Guidelines being validated at sector level while individual schools are already collecting children's biometrics for a fee, unapproved, is the gap between the regime being written and the practice on the ground.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	The King was elected Chairperson of the SADC Organ in August 2026, and Eswatini sits in the ICT ministerials that endorsed the regional digital strategy. The 46th ordinary summit in Durban elected the King Chairperson of the Organ on Politics, Defence and Security Cooperation; no digital or ICT portfolio attaches to the role on the base (communique). Eswatini attended the June 2023 ICT ministerial, which endorsed the draft SADC Digital Transformation Strategy and approved the SADC Postal Strategy 2022-2025 (ministerial). Regional data-protection work reaches national practice through the adequacy model in force for cross-border transfers, and technical assistance is funded to connect national systems into a federated regional electronic know-your-customer framework. The pattern is attendance and endorsement. No SADC digital instrument on the base carries an Eswatini implementation date. 2026-09-03 - a second regional channel opened: the Digital Cooperation Organization's secretary-general met the ICT minister on accelerating digital transformation, the country presenting 1.76m mobile connections against a population of about 1.3m and 95% fourth-generation coverage. Exploratory talks with no memorandum, work programme or membership step recorded, and the figures are the government's own.	MOVEMENT

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Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	SADC ministers urged ratification of the Malabo Convention in 2019; it reached Eswatini's senators for ratification in July 2026 and is not ratified. The September 2019 ministerial urged member states to consider ratifying the African Union Convention on Cyber Security and Personal Data Protection, and approved regional frameworks including mobile broadband gap analysis guidelines and a framework for a regional computer incident response team (ministerial). Seven years later the ICT minister presented Malabo, alongside the Budapest and Tampere Conventions, to senators for ratification (workshop). The one regional instrument the base records as in force domestically is the SADC adequacy model for cross-border data transfers, applying since the Data Protection Act commenced. A regional cybersecurity framework was approved regionally in 2026 with no national implementing instrument recorded.	NO CHANGE urged in 2019 and at the presentation stage in 2026
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A cross-border backbone route to Maputo and onward to undersea cable at Cape Town is the one shared regional asset the base records Eswatini using. The universal access fund and the national backbone operator built an alternative cross-border route to Maputo over powerline fibre, reaching undersea-cable access at Cape Town, in response to frequent backbone and internet failures (programme). A subsea cable system for the Indian Ocean Basin was announced in September 2025 and framed by its operator as a gateway for landlocked southern African and east African markets to reduce reliance on single routes (announcement). No Eswatini commitment to it is held. International capacity on the national backbone stands at 72 Gbps. For a landlocked country every route is somebody else's infrastructure, and the base holds one operating route and one announcement.	NO CHANGE one operating cross-border route and one announcement
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	Regional transfers are permitted under conditions by the Data Protection Act, while a United States bilateral health agreement has data-sharing terms that remain unpublished. The Act permits transfers within the regional bloc under conditions, which is an adequacy model written into the statute (bloc). The health memorandum was announced in August 2026. A federal complaint records that the State Department entered into dozens of such bilateral agreements between December 2025 and February 2026, each typically a memorandum plus at least one further data-sharing agreement, that a freedom-of-information request of December 2025 covers this country's agreements, and that the department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then withdrew public access. The data-sharing terms remain unpublished (agreement). So the statute governs regional transfers on published conditions and the largest bilateral transfer arrangement runs on terms nobody outside the parties can read. A regional federated know-your-customer layer is being funded: technical assistance was announced in August 2025 to connect national digital identity systems across 16 member states over the existing regional settlement and immediate-clearing payment systems (framework). The announcement is the implementing partners' rather than the regional secretariat's, and names no Eswatini commitment, date or instrument.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National interoperability standards	No national interoperability standard is published. The ICT ministry's own report records the e-government interoperability framework under review. The ministry's report to Parliament for 2024/25 records GovStack-model application development and a review of the electronic-government interoperability framework; the framework itself is not held (report). The draft data governance policy proposes Mchumanisi as the exchange platform, which is an architecture rather than a standard (proposal). Where standards have been adopted they are sectoral: the health information exchange runs a master patient index with deterministic and probabilistic matching. More than half of ministries lack meaningful system interoperability, which is the condition a standard would exist to change. Two of the three sources staged for this indicator did not reach the base, so what is held here is thinner than the search behind it.	NO CHANGE a framework under review and none published
Standards	National quality standards	Nineteen new national standards were designated in 2025 and certification cottage factories began construction in December. The standards authority is constituted by an Act assented in 2001; a 2025 account of the new designations cites a later Standards and Quality Act of 2023 as the enabling statute, and that Act is not held (Act). Nineteen new national standards were designated across electricity, fuel facilities, liquefied petroleum gas, food production, beverages, climate change adaptation and household consumer products (designations). Construction began in December 2025 on certification cottage factories at Lugongolweni under a scheme aimed at conformity for the smallest producers (factories). No count of certified organisations, and no conformity-assessment accreditation, is published.	MOVEMENT
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The standards authority's IT catalogue lists 28 domesticated ISO standards, and national addressing standards were launched in July 2026. The information-technology catalogue lists 28 standards domesticated under the SZNS designation, among them the ISO records-management standard and the Dublin Core metadata element set (catalogue). The Eswatini National Addressing Standards, the ISO 19160 parts 1 and 2 domesticated as SZNS, launched on 20 July 2026 with the communications regulator and the ICT and housing ministries (launch). Ten days earlier the authority certified the revenue service to the domesticated ISO 9001 quality management standard (certification). Domestication is running ahead of certification: the catalogue is a shelf of adopted standards, and the base records one certified public body.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	The national data policy was drafted and validated through workshops taking in the private sector, civil society and academia. A two-day stakeholders' workshop opened on 29 April 2026 with European Union, member state and GIZ support to begin drafting the national data policy (workshop), and a validation workshop in July put the draft to government ministries, regulators, the private sector, civil society, academia and development partners (validation). The standing structure for it is provided rather than operating: the Computer Crime and Cybercrime Act establishes a National Cybersecurity Advisory Council, and no appointment, membership or meeting record is held (Act). Where non-government scrutiny has bitten it was after the fact, in the public account demanded of a cloud memorandum after a contradiction between ministry and company. Participation on this base is by invitation to a workshop, not by a standing right to be consulted.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The prime minister first dismissed a memorandum with a hyperscaler, then acknowledged in writing that Cabinet had approved it. A former minister defended the memorandum publicly and the attorney-general confirmed that Cabinet and legal consultation preceded signature (defence, account). The published analysis argues the memorandum was not the real problem. What the exchange establishes for this frame is narrower and sufficient: a head of government publicly denied and then confirmed the existence of an approved instrument, in writing, and that correction happened because the question was pressed in public.	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The ICT capital line for 2026/27 is E47.5 million, of which E17.5 million is government money and E30 million is not. The first draft estimates for 2026/27 to 2028/29 give the ICT head a capital appropriation of E47.5 million for 2026/27, split E17.5 million from government funds and E30 million from other funds (estimates). Under two fifths of the capital line is domestically financed. The budget speech puts E413.9 million to the ICT ministry for its programmes (budget speech), and the largest digital programme in the country runs on E1.2 billion of external money. The revenue side is where the pressure sits: the tax gap stands at E4.4 billion, and an electronic invoicing programme was launched in May 2026 against it. Domestic financing of digital transformation is therefore falling as a share while the absolute programme grows, which is what Regressed means here.	REGRESSED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Digital transformation was named a priority area at a leaders' meeting with a bilateral partner in Taipei. The meeting's own date is not established and the report is dated August 2026 (meeting). No memorandum, workstream, value or timetable is named. Against a unit whose forward programme rests on one lender operation and one hyperscaler memorandum, a named priority area at a leaders' meeting is the whole of this bilateral relationship on the digital record.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Non-state money arrives from three directions: a World Bank project of E1.1 billion, a Taiwan-funded smart city expansion, and a domestic sponsor. The Digital Eswatini project is approved at E648 million for broadband and E450 million for digital government (approval), against a US\$165 million opportunity the same institution had identified. The ICT minister signed a memorandum in March 2026 with a Taiwanese systems integrator extending the 5G government network smart city project from a Mbabane pilot to Manzini and Matsapha, stated as fully funded by the government of Taiwan; no amount is given (agreement). A domestic internet provider put E570,000 into free wireless access across the national trade fair, its third consecutive year (sponsorship). The oldest commitment on the base is still unfinished: a US\$10.4 million India Exim Bank line of credit signed in 2021 for the disaster recovery site (line of credit).	MOVEMENT
New investments	Development-partner project financing	More than E1.06bn of lender financing was approved for a digital project, reported at US\$65m, after the opportunity was noted as absent from the prime minister year-end statement. The financing was approved in mid-2026 and converted in the source at E16.37 to the dollar; the ministry's own quarterly report behind it is not held (financing, appraisal, project). A commentary in January 2026 noted the digital-transformation opportunity as omitted from the prime minister's 2025 year-end statement (omission). The project is the vehicle for the electronic identity, the public-institution connectivity target, the short-code service access and the change-agent training recorded separately — so one operation carries most of the forward programme.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	Mobile coverage against mobile-internet use has not moved, while a smart-city deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 camera systems and public wireless access in the capital. The coverage and usage figures come from the ICT ministry, given at a change-management workshop for the digital project (coverage, reform). The capital's deployment fits a fifth-generation network, 59 artificial-intelligence-enabled cameras and public wireless access (deployment). No lawful basis, retention rule or oversight arrangement for the camera network is stated anywhere, and the four laws named as forthcoming alongside it — including critical infrastructure and artificial intelligence — have not appeared.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	Internet usage	The regulator proposed raising the minimum service standard from 2 Mbps to 10 Mbps, and free statutory complaint adjudication runs on windows of one to six months by sector. The proposal was issued as a public notice in July 2026 (proposal). Adjudication is free under the 2013 communications Act, with windows of one month for post and courier, three for broadcasting and six for telecommunications; these are structural provisions of the Act rather than dated state (adjudication). A six-month window for a telecommunications complaint is long enough that the remedy is unlikely to reach the problem it was raised about, and no complaint volume or outcome series is published.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	Mobile affordability	The cost of data as a share of income per head sits above the international affordability threshold. The finding is stated in an August 2025 account and nothing has moved it since (affordability). It is the constraint under the usage gap recorded separately — mobile coverage substantially exceeds mobile-internet use — and no tariff instrument, subsidy or device-financing scheme appears anywhere in this ledger to address it.	NO CHANGE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	International capacity rose from 47 to 72 Gbps, above target, and 1,031 public institutions are targeted for connection under the digital project. The capacity increase was reported in February 2026 as above target (capacity, rollout). The institution target was stated at the project's change-management workshop (institutions). A landlocked country raising international capacity by half in a reporting period is a real gain; it is also why the satellite gateway recorded separately is framed as reducing dependence on cross-border fibre.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	International capacity on the national backbone stands at 72 Gbps, and a June 2026 ruling forced the backbone open after a provider built its own cross-border link. The national fibre backbone carries 72 Gbps of international capacity with rollout continuing (backbone). The national operator complained that a private provider had built its own cross-border fibre link from a border post, bypassing the backbone. The regulator fined the provider E150,000 and directed the operator to give reliable, non-discriminatory and transparent backbone access and to share its existing connections and fibre topology with internet service providers, effective 1 July 2026 (ruling). The alternative route out of the country runs to Maputo over powerline fibre and onward to undersea cable at Cape Town (programme). No per-operator bandwidth table, utilisation figure or price is published, so the 72 Gbps cannot be read against demand.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points	A national internet exchange point was launched in April 2014 under the African Union's exchange-point project; nothing later is held. The African Union Commission launched the exchange point with the ICT ministry and the Internet Society on 10 April 2014, to keep intra-country traffic inside the country rather than routing it abroad (launch). Twelve years on the base holds no peering-member count, no traffic figure, and no statement that it is operating. The one adjacent fact the base does hold points the other way: the regulator had to order the national operator in June 2026 to share its backbone and fibre topology with internet service providers, which is the interconnection problem an exchange point exists to solve at the traffic layer.	NO CHANGE launched in 2014 with nothing published since

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A government satellite gateway was commissioned to reach mountainous and remote areas and reduce dependence on cross-border fibre, and a business reseller channel launched as a joint venture. The gateway was commissioned in April 2026, its stated purpose reaching mountainous and remote areas and reducing dependence on cross-border fibre (gateway). A joint venture launched as an authorised business reseller in July 2025 (reseller). A government-commissioned gateway is an unusual arrangement — most units in this frame record licensing and resale rather than state operation — and no capacity, coverage or cost figure is published for it.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	A government assessment finds ministries depend heavily on the National Data Centre with no internal fallback. The assessment finding is that dependence is heavy and internal fallback absent (assessment, centre). No capacity, tenancy, availability or redundancy figure is published for the facility itself. A single national facility with no ministry-level fallback is a concentration risk the state's own assessment names and nothing on record answers.	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	The National Data Centre has been complete since 2021 and no rack, power or utilisation figure has been published for it since. The 2021 budget speech records the National Data Centre complete at the science park, and government pursuing amalgamation of its computer services department into the park to centralise ICT resources (speech). Five years on the centre operates and is named a structural concentration of state information, with no capacity disclosure — rack count, megawatts, uptime tier or utilisation — at any date. Power for it is still being sourced five years after the facility opened. Separately, E35 million was allocated in the 2026/27 budget to upgrade the government mainframe, the budget speech naming frequent downtime as the reason (budget speech).	NO CHANGE one national facility and no capacity figure at any date
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A disaster recovery site was funded in 2021 with E58 million and an India Exim line of credit; in October 2025 the regulator was still tendering consultancy for one. The 2021 budget speech records construction begun on a disaster recovery site at KaLanga in the Lubombo region, with E58 million allocated, to put the national data centre among the top data centres in the world (speech). It was financed by a US\$10.4 million India Exim Bank line of credit signed that year for the science park's second phase (line of credit). Four years later the communications regulator advertised a tender for consultancy services on a data centre disaster recovery facility (tender). Nothing on the base records the KaLanga site operating. Beneath it, 9 of 21 ministries keep no regular backups at all.	STALLED
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	The ICT minister met a Gulf clean-energy firm to discuss dedicated supply for the National Data Centre, and nothing has been signed. The meeting took place at an international government summit in February 2026 and nothing was signed (supply, discussions). Dedicated power for the single national facility on which ministries have no fallback is the right problem to be working on. That it is at the stage of an unsigned discussion is the state of it. The published tariff schedule is where this can be tested, and it does not carry the category: an average increase of 13.61 per cent was approved for 2026/27 and revised down to 11.74 per cent after special government funding, effective 1 April 2026, across a lifeline domestic band and time-of-use commercial tariffs, with no data-centre or large-load category anywhere in it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification	Electrification reached 88 per cent at the 2024/25 year end, and a rural access project stood at 5,600 of 8,000 targeted connections in October 2025. The energy regulator's annual report puts the electrification rate at 88 per cent at the 2024/25 year end, on 298,918 customers and 126 MW of installed capacity (annual report). A World Bank-financed network reinforcement and energy access project targets 8,000 household connections in the Shiselweni region (mission report). By October 2025 it had connected 5,600 of them, 70 per cent, up from 5,111 in April, with 6,500 sought by the project's December closure and the remainder carried into a successor project aiming at universal access by 2030 (mission report). The project disbursed its full EUR 35.7 million and was rated satisfactory at the mission (mission report). No rural-only access rate is published, so the national figure cannot be split between town and country.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	A Digital Landscape Assessment found ministry data backup and ICT maintenance wanting and government systems not interoperable, with critical state information at risk in nine ministries. The assessment was received and endorsed by the ICT ministry, so the finding is the government's own rather than an outside audit (backups). Interoperability between government systems is a finding of the same assessment (interoperability). A state that has endorsed an assessment saying critical information is at risk in nine ministries, while running everything on one data centre with no ministry-level fallback, has documented its own exposure. The assessment is also what the electronic-government strategy is being founded on, which is the right response and has not yet produced a strategy.	REGRESSED
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The digital readiness assessment puts the country at the systematic stage across all six pillars, and 18 ICT professionals support the assessed government estate. The assessment, published in November 2024, places the country at the systematic stage across all six pillars — digital public infrastructure, connectivity, government, regulation, economy and people (assessment). The audit evidence beneath it is specific: 31 of 419 government services are online, 15 of 22 ministries run on 1 Mbps or less, and 18 ICT professionals support the assessed estate; 9 of 21 ministries keep no regular backups and 11 have no ICT maintenance contract. Against that, change agents are in training across ministries under the digitisation programme, and the auditor-general's 2026-2030 strategic plan urges more than 80 audit officers to take up artificial intelligence and digital methods. Neither the training nor the plan carries a headcount target for the technical staff the estate is short of.	NO CHANGE a diagnosed shortage and training under way against it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	A regional cybersecurity framework was finalised and approved at a subcommittee hosted in-country, and a national awareness month was opened by the prime minister. A government mobile application testing laboratory was opened, funded and supported by the Republic of China (Taiwan) (opening). The regional framework was finalised and approved by a central bank governors' subcommittee at a meeting in the country in July 2026 (framework). Cybersecurity awareness month was opened by the prime minister in October 2025 (awareness). Neither is a national instrument. The country has no cybersecurity statute — one was named as forthcoming a year ago — no incident response team on record, and no incident, caseload or capability figure anywhere in this ledger. Enforcement has a unit behind it: a police digital forensic unit and cyber task team had made 87 arrests and submitted 528 dockets to the prosecutions director by October 2025, working on mobile money fraud, fake wallet schemes, online loan scams and rental scams. Over E8.5 million was involved in cyber-related crime in the twelve months to 30 September 2025.	MOVEMENT

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	Mchumanisi is proposed as the national exchange platform in a draft policy; more than half of ministries still lack meaningful interoperability. The draft data governance policy names Mchumanisi as the platform through which authorised institutions would reach information a citizen supplies once (proposal). The ICT ministry's report to Parliament for 2024/25 records a Government In Your Hand platform soon to launch and the electronic-government interoperability framework under review (report). Where exchange exists it is sectoral: a health information exchange runs a master patient index with deterministic and probabilistic matching, and the revenue service is integrating national databases for data matching. The measure against all of it is the audit finding that more than half of ministries lack meaningful system interoperability. Mchumanisi is a proposal with no specification, procurement or date.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	A national e-KYC registry is under construction to let banks and ministries verify identity against one record, targeting 500,000 users by 2028. The registry is under construction with a cross-border dimension inside the regional bloc, and the FinTech Strategy targets 500,000 users of it by 2028 (registry, strategy). The health information exchange already matches patients to one identity through a master patient index using deterministic and probabilistic methods, which is the base's only operating instance of a shared identity across systems. The revenue service is integrating national databases for data matching, with taxpayers segmented four ways. The constraint is the credential: the national identity card does not meet the criteria for digital identification, and the digital identity itself remains planned under the Digital Eswatini project.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	A master patient index feeds a standards-based exchange, and dispensing in the clinical system now updates stock in the logistics system. The master patient index, matching patients deterministically and probabilistically and integrated with the population registry, feeds a standards-based health information exchange (exchange). In-country developers completed training in the first quarter of 2026 producing automated data flows from the clinical system into the district health information platform, aligned to the health interoperability standard (first quarter). A June 2026 workshop validated a live integration under which dispensing a medicine in the clinical system updates stock in the logistics system, implemented so far for antiretroviral medicines (integration). Health is the one sector on this base where interoperability is running rather than proposed. Legacy systems elsewhere in the sector remain fragmented on the health agency's own account.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems	The education management information system is keyed to a personal identification number and stated by government to allow linkage with other systems. Government's own performance report records the system launched as a real-time platform keyed to a personal identification number and allowing linkages with other management information systems (report). Disability indicators were integrated into it in November 2025 with more than 900 staff trained, and the stated next priority is connecting it to other disability-tracking systems (integration). The finance minister's 2026 budget speech names it as a benchmark for education data management (budget speech). No actual linkage to another government system is recorded as operating, and most rural primary schools still collect on paper.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems	The social registry reached its second region in August 2026, and the provident fund is cleaning client records ahead of pension conversion. A second regional rollout began in Lubombo in August 2026 on an E41.7 million data-collection exercise, after 44,683 households were registered in the first region (rollout). The deputy prime minister's office had reported the registry under development with project documents finalised and a first regional pilot from March 2025 (annual report). The national provident fund reports going paperless and beginning a know-your-customer data-cleaning exercise on client records ahead of conversion into a national pension scheme (fund). Both are preparing data rather than exchanging it: nothing on the base records the registry reading from, or writing to, another government system.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	Electronic identities are planned under the digital project for a 2027 rollout, and national card production resumed in February 2026 after a suspension from late September 2025. Electronic identities are planned for a 2027 rollout, on a readiness report first published in 2024 (plan, readiness). Production of the existing national card was suspended in late September 2025 and resumed on 22 February 2026; the card is not a digital identity (resumption, regulation). No cause, backlog figure or remediation is published for the five-month suspension. A credential system that stopped issuing for five months, in the same period its ministry published unblurred identity documents and missed the breach-notification duty, is the base on which the 2027 electronic identity is to be built.	MIXED electronic identity planned for 2027 while national card production was suspended for five months

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Birth registration completeness reached 61 per cent in 2025 and death registration 62 per cent, against 8.3 and 26.5 per cent in 2016. The 2022 annual vital statistics report put completeness at 35.6 per cent of births and 55 per cent of deaths (report). The 2025 figures announced at the ninth Africa civil registration day are 61 per cent of births and 62 per cent of deaths, against 8.3 and 26.5 per cent in 2016 (commemoration). The 2025 report itself is not held as a downloadable government publication. The population register is a compulsory register of every birth, marriage and death since 1984, and is a paper-based statute not shown to be digitised. The 2027 census is the next whole-population count, with household mapping begun and E130.5 million allocated. Two in five births are still unregistered.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	Identity card production resumed in February 2026 after a suspension for technical upgrades, and in August the ministry asked citizens to verify the chief code on their documents. Production resumed at ten service centres in February 2026 after a pause for technical upgrades, with a plan to clear the resulting backlog (resumption). In August 2026 the ministry asked citizens to check that the chief code on their identity documents matches their actual chiefdom, warning that an incorrect code creates difficulty in reaching government services, and describing how corrections are made in the civil registration system (campaign). The statutory basis is the Identification Order of 1998, which establishes the population register and the personal identity number (Order). The card does not meet the criteria for digital identification. No issuance figure, backlog size or correction count is published at any date.	MIXED production restored after a suspension while a campaign asks citizens to correct the records themselves
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	The central bank is standing up a national electronic know-your-customer registry to digitise identity verification. The registry was reported in September 2025 (registry). No go-live, participant count or governing instrument is published. It would be the country's first authentication layer, and it is being built by the central bank rather than by the identity or ICT authorities – so the first working identity verification in the state may sit inside the financial regulator.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth	The Closing of the Tap initiative registers newborns inside health facilities under the Civil Registration Act of 2023, with offices in seven towns. The ministry's own retrospective describes the Civil Registration Act of 2023 and an initiative registering newborns directly within health facilities, with registration offices now open in seven towns (ministry). A unique identification number is issued at birth and appears on both the birth-registration record and the birth certificate (scoping study). Registration completeness stands at 61 per cent of births in 2025 (commemoration), so the pathway exists for rather more than half of newborns. What is issued at birth is a number and a certificate, not a credential: the identity document itself comes at 16 under the 1998 Order, and no count of births registered through the health-facility route is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id	A unique identification number issued at birth appears on both the registration record and the certificate, linking civil registration to the population register. A seven-country regional scoping study confirms that a unique identification number is issued at birth and carried on both the birth-registration record and the birth certificate (study). The annual vital statistics report is the base's clearest primary description of how that number assignment links registration to the national population register (report). The draft data governance policy names birth-certificate services among the intended uses of the proposed national exchange platform (proposal). The same study finds registrars in some of the seven countries making a citizenship determination at the point of birth registration, which is a linkage that decides status rather than merely records it.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	The e-KYC registry is being built so banks and ministries can verify against one identity record, with 500,000 users targeted by 2028. The central bank convened banks, financial-service providers and government ministries around a national identity-verification registry, with a cross-border dimension inside the regional bloc (registry). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 commits to it, targeting 500,000 users and 80 per cent interoperability by 2028 (strategy). Technical assistance is funded to connect the national system into a federated regional framework. Against the commitments, the credential itself does not qualify: the national identity card does not meet the criteria for digital identification, and no verification volume is published for any system.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	A National FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 was launched by the central bank governor and the finance minister, above a digital currency design paper published in 2024. The strategy was launched in December 2025, framed around reducing reliance on cash (strategy, cash). The design paper is not an issuance decision, and no pilot, launch date or governance arrangement follows it (paper). The central bank's annual integrated reports are held for two successive years, the later superseding a payment-switch participation series the base had carried from earlier reporting (report, prior). The settlement layer under all of it is old and undocumented since: the interbank payment and settlement system runs under a rulebook adopted by its steering committee in May 2007 (rulebook), and the central bank describes its role as facilitating development and overseeing the safety and soundness of national payment systems (mandate). No revision of the rulebook, and no volume or value statistic for the system, is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	A social grant disbursement system built with the science park moved bank-paid elderly grants to the 25th of the month from August 2026. The deputy prime minister's office introduced the system to make grant payment safer, faster and more reliable, shifting the bank-paid elderly grant date from the 20th to the 25th (system). Its own annual report gives the operational split of elderly-grant payment between mobile money and bank accounts for April to December 2024 (annual report). 35 post offices accept government-service payments, which is the counter-flow from citizen to state. No disbursement value, recipient count or failure rate is published for the new system, and the social registry that would target it has covered one region of four.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	An electronic invoicing programme launched in May 2026 against an estimated E4.259 billion annual tax gap, and customs payments now clear in near real time. The programme was launched on 11 May 2026 with a Serbian technology vendor engaged to build it, presented as the answer to an estimated E4.259 billion annual leakage (launch), and rollout began with wholesale and retail businesses (rollout). The revenue service and a commercial bank integrated their payment systems in June 2026 so customs payments reflect on the trade platform in near real time, replacing manual bank-statement reconciliation (integration). An integrated revenue administration system has been running since March 2024 (budget speech). No enrolled-business count and no revenue effect is published for the invoicing programme, so the gap it was built to close cannot yet be measured against it.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality	All bank and non-bank participants are connected to the payment switch's round-the-clock fast-payments platform, on a wholesale system running since 2007. The interbank payment and settlement system has operated under its 2007 rulebook since then, and is the wholesale rail beneath business and government payments (rulebook). The finance minister told Parliament in February 2026 that all bank and non-bank participants are connected to the payment switch's 24-hour fast-payments platform (budget speech); the eighth and final participant went live on 15 November 2025 (remarks). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 targets 80 per cent interoperability by 2028 (strategy). Against the rails, more than 90 per cent of person-to-business payments are still cash (survey), and no business-to-business or business-to-government transaction volume is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	The payment switch launched fast payments as phase one of three, and 35 post offices opened for government-service payments. Fast payments launched as phase one of three; no source held confirms whether the remaining five participants went live as expected by end-January 2025 (launch, explainer). Thirty-five post offices were opened for government-service payments in September 2025 (post offices). A rail whose participant list cannot be confirmed eighteen months after phase one, alongside a physical over-the-counter channel, is where person-to-government payment actually stands here.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Account ownership rose on a global survey cited in the record, against a cash share of person-to-business payments the lender assessed as high. The account ownership figure is a reference-study figure, cited rather than absorbed (ownership), and the cash share comes from a lender assessment of digital public infrastructure (cash). The mobile money platform migrated to a cloud-native vendor platform across four markets; the performance figures are the vendor's own and no downtime, cost or subscriber-impact figure is stated (migration). Neither uptake figure is a domestic series, so what the payment switch and the post-office channel changed cannot be measured from this base.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Migration of regional low-value flows to a bloc settlement system is reported under way with no timetable, and accession to a continental payment system was discussed with a bilateral partner. The migration is reported as under way with no timetable, volume, value or mandating instrument given (migration). The central bank governor discussed leveraging another country's experience to accelerate continental accession (accession). Both are cross-border commitments stated in the same bilateral meeting account, and neither has a date.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection	A finance portfolio committee tabled a report on bank transaction charges and recommended the central bank report a comparative benchmark within 30 days of adoption. The report was tabled in July 2026 (report) with a recommendation that the central bank produce a comparative benchmark of charges within 30 days of adoption (benchmark). No adoption date, benchmark or central bank response is on record. Legislative scrutiny of transaction pricing is rare in this frame and worth recording as such; whether it produced anything is unestablished.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Population register	A compulsory civil register has run since January 1984 under a 1983 statute, and nothing in the base shows it has been digitised. The register commenced on 6 January 1984 under a births, marriages and deaths registration Act, administered by a registrar in the home affairs ministry (statute, assessment). It is a paper-based statute and nothing shows digitisation. The electronic identity planned for 2027 would therefore be built on a register whose current form is unrecorded, in the ministry whose card production stopped for five months and which is under investigation for a data breach.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Civil register	A proposed DNA requirement for birth certificates is costed at about E126m a year, roughly 46 per cent of the home affairs budget. The costing is reported against the ministry's budget (proposal). It is a proposal only. Requiring genetic testing to register a birth would be the most invasive civil-registration rule in this frame, and the account that reaches the base is about its cost rather than its lawful basis, consent model or effect on registration rates. The improvement work has a structure behind it: a national steering committee and technical working group were established under a continental mentorship programme whose second phase launched in February 2022 (programme), with a university partner supporting the government since 2015 on foreign health-programme funding (support). Over 10,000 of the births occurring in 2021 were registered late.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Address register	National addressing standards launched in July 2026 with two municipal pilots; no address register exists yet. The Eswatini National Addressing Standards, the ISO 19160 parts 1 and 2 domesticated as SZNS, launched on 20 July 2026 by the standards authority with the communications regulator and the ICT and housing ministries (launch). Mbabane is leading implementation of a national street addressing and house numbering programme, framed as a smart-city initiative to make deliveries, emergency response and navigation work (Mbabane), and Ezulwini is among the pilot municipalities (Ezulwini). What exists is a standard and two pilots. No address register, no count of addressed properties and no national coverage figure is held, and the standard is six weeks old at the close of this window.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	Company registration runs online with incorporation in a day, and a Bill to replace the 2009 Act and digitise registration is between the two Houses. Company name search and reservation run online with incorporation in a day (procedure), and a one-stop shop for investors opened in July 2025 offering a trading licence and a taxpayer number in one place. The Companies Bill of 2024, which would replace the Companies Act of 2009 and digitise company registration, passed the House of Assembly on 18 September 2025 (passage) and the Senate moved on 5 March 2026 to take it at the stage it had reached (order paper). The Bill is not assented or commenced, so the register still runs under a statute of 2009 (Act). No count of registered companies, or of registrations completed online, is published at any date.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Social protection register	A social registry is piloting in one of four regions, with 44,683 households enrolled and targeting run on a proxy means test. The national dynamic social registry published the results of its Shiselweni region pilot, including disability data (results). The Shiselweni pilot covered 47,766 households, registered 44,683 of them and recorded 3,088 as vacant or non-consenting, against a projected 47,260 households in the region. Targeting uses a proxy means test built on 20 variables from the household income and expenditure survey, and the programme carries US\$2.5 million, about E42.5 million, of World Bank funding; each region is to be given three months to implement. No national rollout date, no statement of which grant programmes will draw on the registry, and no data-protection or grievance arrangement for it, are on record.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Electoral register	The commission runs continuous voter registration, and a proposed compulsory chief code and residency rule are under review. Continuous voter registration was operationalised from 19 to 28 September 2025 for two by-election divisions, open to newly eligible voters and to prospective candidates (registration). The commission's own account of the process describes voter registration on an optical-mark-recognition identification system, production of a preliminary register and validation at chiefdom level (process). A proposal to make the chief code compulsory at registration, alongside a six-month residency rule, divided residents at Ezulwini and is under commission review (debate). The same code is the one the home affairs ministry asked citizens to correct on their identity documents in August 2026. No registered-voter count is held at any date on this base.	MOVEMENT
Registries	Tax register	Taxpayer identification number registration is free but paper-based, on a form collected from an office or downloaded, with twelve supporting documents. The procedure is free and administered by the revenue service under the value added tax statute, with the form collected from an office or downloaded and twelve supporting documents required, from a certified certificate of incorporation to evidence of a fixed place of business and the capacity to keep accounting records (procedure). There is no online submission route, which sits against company registration in the same ministry running through the government portal (company). No count of registered taxpayers is published, and the underlying forms the procedure page links carry dates of April 2020.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	The deeds registry is still manual, with the registrar stating an intention to move to a fully electronic system after two study missions in five months. A delegation from the deeds registry and the science and technology park made a five-day study visit to a neighbouring land registry in August 2025, the second such mission in five months, the first having been led by the principal secretary for natural resources and energy (mission). The registrar stated that registration and storage of deeds remain manual and that the country is working to upgrade them into a fully electronic system (position). No system, procurement, budget line or date for that upgrade is on record, and no parcel or title count is published.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Health	Community health services moved from paper to digital records, and a regional artificial-intelligence health partnership was signed in-country with a private firm. The transition from paper to digital records in community health services is documented in February 2026 (transition). A memorandum between a regional health body and a private firm to scale artificial-intelligence health solutions was signed in the country in August 2026 (partnership). Advisory guidelines on processing personal health data were still in validation workshops at that point, so the partnership and the digitisation are both ahead of the guidance meant to govern them. Underneath the policy the record system is in place: an open-source, government-owned electronic medical record is live at 233 sites, 73 per cent of health facilities, keyed on a unique identity number with role-based access and backed up in government-owned cloud systems, so a patient's history follows them between districts.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A school education management information system went national in March 2024, carrying individual learner and staff records keyed to a personal identification number. The system was launched nationally between 19 and 22 March 2024, after a pilot begun in 2020 and testing in ten schools. It replaces semi-annual paper returns entered centrally into a desktop database, carries both aggregate education data and individual learner and staff records identified by a personal identification number, and was built on an open-source platform by the education ministry with a UN agency, a university and two implementing partners (implementation). Unreliable internet, a shortage of school-owned devices and limited digital skills leave most rural primary schools collecting enrolment, attendance and learner data on paper for later entry (constraints). No enrolment count or data-sharing arrangement with the population register is published.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The social registry reached its second region in August 2026 on an E41.7 million exercise, after 44,683 households in the first. The deputy prime minister's office reported the registry under development with project documents finalised and a first regional pilot from March 2025 (annual report). 44,683 households were registered in the first region out of 47,766 covered, with 3,088 vacant or non-consenting, and targeting runs on a proxy means test of 20 variables from the household income and expenditure survey (first region). A second rollout began in Lubombo in August 2026 on an E41.7 million data-collection exercise (Lubombo). Two of four regions in two years, and no statement that the registry has yet carried a live targeting decision for a grant.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	An integrated electronic case management system launched in August 2025 is being extended across the justice sector, with no live-service statement yet. The system was launched by the justice ministry on 18 August 2025, beginning end-user capacity building across the sector (system). It is designed to replace paper filing with electronic case filing, virtual hearings and case tracking, and to connect the judiciary, the justice ministry, the law society, the police, the anti-corruption commission and correctional services on one platform; a development agency donated the equipment (design). Parliamentary portfolio committees were briefed on 20 May 2026, where the senate president raised the security of court files in the system (briefing). No case volume, court coverage or go-live date is published.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	Online filing has been compulsory since 2022, and the revenue service is procuring fiscalisation and electronic invoicing to close an E4.4 billion tax gap. Online filing was made compulsory for income tax payers with a zero-cash-handling payment policy; an independent evaluation found registered taxpayers 60 per cent less likely to file nil returns and 70 per cent more likely to pay once they had filed (mandate). The tax gap stands at E4.4 billion, with wholesale and retail the largest contributor, chiefly in value added tax, and the compliance improvement plan segments taxpayers four ways and names analytics and fiscalisation as the detection method. A fiscalisation and electronic invoicing system went to the market in May 2025, specified for real-time invoice reporting, fiscal devices integrated with revenue systems and predictive targeting of high-risk taxpayers; no award, supplier or value is on record (procurement). The national business body backed the electronic invoicing move on 7 September while asking that affordability and technology neutrality be settled before the national rollout. The asks are asks, not commitments obtained.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	Customs	Customs runs on ASYCUDAWorld 4.4 since December 2024, and payments from one commercial bank now clear on it in near real time. The trade body's 2025 report records migration to ASYCUDAWorld version 4.4 in December 2024 with locally developed customs modules (report). The revenue service and a commercial bank integrated their payment systems in June 2026 so customs payments reflect on the platform in near real time, replacing manual bank-statement reconciliation (integration). Ten border agencies endorsed an inter-agency standard-operating-procedure framework and a national data catalogue aligned to the customs data model in November 2025, under a project backed by the World Customs Organization (framework). The integration covers one bank. No clearance-time, declaration-volume or single-window figure is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Land	The deeds system reached a phase-2 prototype at 60 per cent in October 2024, and registry staff were trained on sectional title in July 2026. Government's own quarterly report to Parliament records the deeds registration and information management system at a phase-2 prototype, 60 per cent complete and under testing for gradual rollout (report). A registry delegation benchmarked Kenya's land platform in August 2025 while preparing a fully electronic system, with registration and storage of deeds still manual at that point (benchmarking). In July 2026 the deeds registry and the surveyor-general's department were trained by South African specialists on sectional plans and sectional-title deeds (training). Two years on from that prototype no go-live date, budget or system name is held, and the registry itself describes a department whose records came from Pretoria in 1973 (registry).	MOVEMENT
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	A citizen application and a tax application launched together, and the prime minister told the House that a memorandum signed without proper consideration for data protection is meaningless. Both applications launched in May 2025, for government services and for tax accounts and clearance certificates (launch, applications). The prime minister's own words — that the application must be watertight, that his office does not support outsourcing data to global technology companies, and that a memorandum signed without proper consideration for data protection is meaningless — are in his written responses tabled to the House of Assembly in March 2026 (responses, criticism). An assessment count of government services available online is held (services), and an electronic-government strategy is being founded on that same assessment with nothing yet produced (strategy).	MIXED two citizen applications live while the prime minister states a memorandum signed without proper data-protection consideration is meaningless

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	Thirty-eight constituency centres are included in the digital project's connectivity target. The centres are part of the 1,031-institution target (centres). No timetable, service list or per-centre arrangement is published. Constituency centres are the tier at which most citizens meet the state in this country, so their inclusion in the connectivity target is the single most consequential line in it.	MOVEMENT
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	The Tinkhundla ministry's report records no digital record-keeping for local administration, and none of 38 targeted centres is reported connected. The ministry's own report to Parliament for 2024/25 covers its mandate, decentralisation policy and the reconstruction of Tinkhundla centres, and records no digital record-keeping system for local administration (report). 38 Tinkhundla centres are targeted for connectivity and none is reported connected. The World Bank grant funds a consultancy to write a roadmap for digitising about 200 government services, which is where local records would be reached if they are reached (procurement plan). Local government is the layer at which a citizen meets the state most often, and it is the layer on which this base holds least.	NO CHANGE no local records system on the base and connectivity not yet delivered

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics	A community health information system launched in September 2025 moved rural health motivators off paper to offline-capable digital capture. The health ministry launched the system with United Nations and World Bank partners, alongside a community-based health strategy (launch). A year earlier the ministry's own annual report recorded facility data collection running electronically and on paper together (annual report). The health agency's 2025 results report records optimisation of the district health information platform and enhanced interoperability across major programmes, while flagging still-fragmented legacy systems (results report). Community health services are digitised on the base's own record. No count of clinics running electronically, and no figure for those still on paper, is held.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	402 of 965 mapped schools are connected, and the education ministry states most primary schools are still not. 965 schools are mapped on the international schools-connectivity platform with 402 connected, and the education ministry states most primary schools remain unconnected (briefing). The communications regulator handed 68 devices to the education ministry in December 2025 to support a learning-passport platform and pilot digital-learning demonstration sites in four schools, aimed particularly at rural areas (donation). The education management information system is national in scale and keyed to a personal identification number, and most rural primary schools still collect on paper. Connectivity is the binding layer, and it stands at 402 schools.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices	Short-code access to public services is planned so citizens without smartphones can transact, and 44 devices were handed to agricultural extension officers. Short-code access is planned under the digital project specifically so citizens without smartphones can transact (access). In a country where data cost sits above the affordability threshold, that is the design choice that decides whether the rest of the programme reaches anyone rural. Forty-four devices were handed to extension officers in August 2026, with no officer total, data platform, reporting standard or custodian for the collected field data stated (devices). Field data collected on state-issued devices with no named custodian is a data-protection question the guidelines under validation do not yet reach.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations	The electronic case management system is to be used by the police, and nothing records a system operating at a rural station. A development agency donated equipment worth about US\$10,000 to the justice ministry in August 2025 for the rollout, stating it would be used by the police alongside correctional services and other justice bodies (donation). Judicial officers and court administrators from courts across the country were taken through a three-day change management session in March 2026 ahead of the transition to digital case management (session). The police appear on this base as a named user of a justice-sector system and nowhere as an operator of their own. The national violence strategy names the police service as the actor at station level (strategy). No station count, docket system or connectivity figure for police stations is held, rural or otherwise.	NO CHANGE nothing on the base describes a system at station level

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The Auditor-General launched a 2026-2030 strategic plan integrating artificial intelligence, and the plan text is not held. The plan was launched in August 2026 (plan, integration). No tool, data access, assurance standard or safeguard for audit use of artificial intelligence is stated. A supreme audit institution adopting the technology is consequential — it is the body that would otherwise audit its use elsewhere in government — and the country has no artificial-intelligence strategy or statute at all. 2026-09-07 - the office took the question regionally, hosting a week-long peer programme at which supreme audit institutions across the region weighed the use of artificial intelligence in government audit. No tool, pilot, audit methodology or procurement is named on either occasion; what the base holds is the intention and the forum.	MOVEMENT
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems	Three platforms were launched with an operator covering agriculture, health and the creative economy. The three platforms launched together in June 2026 (platforms). No user count, data arrangement, custodian or public-sector role is published for any of them. Three sectoral platforms delivered through a commercial operator, in a country whose government systems its own assessment finds not interoperable, is a delivery route that works and does not connect to anything.	MOVEMENT
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	The ICT ministry announced a national AI strategy for 2024/25 at the first AI indaba; two years on it is still not held. The ministry and the academy of sciences held the country's first artificial-intelligence indaba in November 2024, at which the ministry announced it would develop a national artificial-intelligence strategy and a fourth industrial revolution strategy in that financial year (indaba). A reviewed science, technology and innovation policy and a combined fourth and fifth industrial revolution strategy went to stakeholder validation in February 2026 (validation). Neither document is held. At continental level the African Union signed a memorandum with a hyperscaler under its own artificial-intelligence strategy, with no Eswatini-specific commitment under it (memorandum). The national artificial-intelligence strategy was probed and not found. What the country has built instead is training: a university academy has put more than 400 professionals through a generative-artificial-intelligence course.	STALLED
AI	Control of AI abuse	The regulator urged broadcasters to manage artificial intelligence and deepfakes ethically and transparently. The guidance was issued in November 2025 (guidance). It is guidance to a single sector, urging rather than requiring, and it is one of the two instruments that carry artificial-intelligence rules in a country with no artificial-intelligence instrument. The other is the online media guidelines.	MOVEMENT
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A provisional banking licence was granted for a transition to a full digital bank. The provisional licence was granted and the transition is under way (licence). No capital, timetable, customer base or launch date is published. It is the only domestic digital-industry item in this ledger apart from platforms delivered by a mobile operator.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	The science park incubator opened an international pitch route in May 2026, and a regional youth hub awarded E42,000 in seed capital in August. The science park's business incubator offers co-working space, business development, intellectual property and fundraising support to early-stage companies (incubator), and in May 2026 launched a national leg of an international startup pitch competition with a venture firm (competition). Fifty young entrepreneurs took a four-week incubation programme at a regional hub run by the youth council with the small enterprise development company, and five won a combined E42,000 in seed capital (programme). Two community innovation hubs are operating with a third planned for a third region, and a training curriculum in artificial intelligence, robotics and cybersecurity is announced for them with no start date, provider or cohort size. No cohort count, graduation figure or investment total is published for the science park's own incubator at any date.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A private accelerator's first cohort passed E1 million in combined revenue, and the FinTech Strategy commits to sandbox expansion. Six entrepreneurs in the first cohort of a privately run accelerator generated more than E1 million in combined revenue within a year, and a second cohort of four businesses launched in August 2026 (accelerator). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 is in force and targets 500,000 electronic know-your-customer users and 80 per cent interoperability by 2028, the base's clearest statement of a startup-finance and sandbox commitment (strategy). The one domestic digital business the base tracks by name holds a provisional banking licence with no launch date. No count of startups, funding raised or exits is published. 2026-09-05 - a state-facing platform changed hands: a Taiwan-funded platform connecting local businesses to wider markets was handed to the investment promotion authority at the international trade fair, with funding for a third-phase scale-up still being sought. No listing count, transaction volume, cost or phase-three budget is published, so a platform is transferred with its running costs unstated. Three days earlier about 150 delegates met at Manzini under a United Nations enterprise programme on cutting small-enterprise costs with digital tools, with no follow-on commitment published.	MOVEMENT

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)	The revenue service signed a 650-employee AI literacy programme with the national university in June 2026. The revenue service and the national university signed a memorandum in June 2026 for an artificial-intelligence literacy programme covering 650 employees (memorandum). The public service ministry's own report for 2024/25 records short-term ICT training for civil servants through the management institute (report). Change agents are in training across ministries under the digitisation programme, and the auditor-general's strategic plan urges more than 80 audit officers to take up artificial intelligence and digital methods. Against it, 18 ICT professionals support the assessed government estate. The training is real and the establishment it trains into is not on the base.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	The ICT minister set a target for digitally skilled citizens, and a domestic practitioner published guidance on digital workplace transformation. The target was set in February 2026 (target) and no programme, budget or measurement method is attached to it. A book by a domestic ICT practitioner is the only other literacy item in the ledger (book). A national skills target with no delivery instrument behind it, in a country whose stated internet-usage and youth-unemployment rates are recorded elsewhere in this report, is an aspiration rather than a programme.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education	The 2018 curriculum framework makes ICT a core skill, and thirty learners took a five-day AI incubator in August 2025. The 2018 curriculum reform defines information and communications technology as a core skill and a subject option across the education system; no later revision is held (framework). A university artificial-intelligence academy ran a five-day incubator giving thirty secondary and state-school learners hands-on artificial-intelligence and machine-learning training (incubator). The communications regulator handed 68 devices to the education ministry in December 2025 for a learning-passport platform and demonstration sites in four schools (donation). Thirty learners and sixty-eight devices against a school system in which most primary schools are unconnected: the curriculum names the skill, and the base holds no enrolment, pass rate or teacher-supply figure for teaching it.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A university AI academy graduated over 400 professionals in June 2026, on a statutory register of accredited computing qualifications. The higher education council's statutory register lists registered institutions and their accredited programmes, including the national university's computing and information-technology degrees, under the Higher Education Act of 2013 (register). More than 400 professionals graduated from the university academy's generative-artificial-intelligence course in June 2026, one of three courses it runs (graduation). The same university's computer science department hosted a two-day deep-learning research workshop in September 2025 with the revenue service, the science park, the central bank and the communications regulator among its supporters (workshop). A university computer science department with a health-informatics research group is the base's one recorded research capability. No enrolment or graduate count for the accredited degrees is published.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	Artificial-intelligence, robotics and cybersecurity training was announced as the next phase at innovation hubs, and cross-ministry change agents are in training for the 2027 rollout. The hub curriculum was announced at a hub handover as the phase beyond basic digital literacy (curriculum). Change agents across ministries are in training for the digital project's 2027 rollout (agents). Neither carries a cohort size, curriculum, completion measure or placement figure. Training change agents ahead of a rollout is the correct order, and it is the only training in this unit tied to a specific delivery date.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	A university computer science department names a health-informatics research group and a cybersecurity and forensics group alongside a masters programme. The department runs undergraduate and masters programmes in computer science, information technology and information science, and lists two research groups, one in health informatics and one in cybersecurity and forensics, with pages for publications and conferences and for research grants (department). It also hosts an ICT fair, a deep learning event and a hackathon, and acknowledges a development agency for sponsoring student data during remote teaching (activity). No funding line, output count or contribution to national digital policy is stated for either group, so what the department contributes to policy is not established.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals	One public entity launched a feedback platform in June 2026; the only government-wide channel is a grievance mechanism committed in a draft project plan. The housing board introduced a net promoter score platform taking feedback across its offices, digital channels and services (platform). It is one entity's own channel. The Digital Eswatini project's stakeholder engagement plan commits to a multi-channel grievance redress mechanism including an online portal (plan); the plan is a draft and carries no portal address, complaint count or response standard. The regulator adjudicates statutory complaints in the communications sector, which is a sectoral route rather than a service-delivery one. 31 of 419 government services are online. A feedback portal for a service that is not online has nothing to be a portal to.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	Budget consultations took the national budget process to the regions in 2025, run in response to a 2023 national forum resolution. The finance minister opened an annual round of regional consultations taking the budget process to citizens, in response to a resolution of the 2023 national forum (consultations). That forum is the constitutional route by which citizens petition: Parliament's own record at the state opening describes it as the standing citizen forum (Parliament). The Prime Minister presented a proposed thirty-year national plan to members of parliament in August 2025 with a call to consult their constituencies (presentation). None of the three produces a document on this base: no attendance figure, no submission count, no constituency report, and no trace of any of it in the estimates.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Gender equity	Fifty women from government institutions formed the first cohort of a digital academy in July 2026; no gendered access figure is held. The country was the African pilot for a women's digital academy, with a first cohort of fifty women drawn from government institutions (academy). The digital readiness assessment identifies women and girls among the groups at risk of digital exclusion, and places the country at the systematic stage across all six pillars (assessment). The FinTech Strategy 2025-2030 commits to new digital financial products for underserved groups by 2028 (strategy). Account ownership stands at 63 per cent, led by mobile money (survey), and is not published split by sex. Neither is internet use, device ownership or digital skill: the base holds a diagnosis, a cohort of fifty and no measurement.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities	The country launched its first costed disability plan in July 2026, and 13 assistive devices were handed to schools in June. The Persons with Disabilities Act of 2018 establishes the national advisory council and a right of access to information and communications technology (Act). Eight years later the first costed national plan of action for 2026-2028 was launched with United Nations cultural-organisation support, as the funded implementation roadmap for that Act (plan); no budget figure for it is held. The communications regulator's universal access fund handed 474 smartphones for vulnerable citizens and 13 specialised assistive devices, including screen and braille readers, to the education ministry for learners with visual impairments (handover). Disability indicators were integrated into the education management information system in November 2025, which is the first step towards counting the learners the devices are for.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	77 machine-readable travel documents were dispatched to refugees between April and June 2026, on a statute in force since 2018. The Refugees Act of 2017, commenced in November 2018, provides for the recognition, protection and control of refugees and establishes the commissioner for refugees (Act). The refugee department received 82 applications for machine-readable convention travel documents in the first quarter of 2026/27 and dispatched 77, alongside 70 refugee status permits (quarterly figures). A regional refugee-agency report names the country among those incorporating refugees and asylum-seekers into national civil registration and documentation systems (report). The documents are machine-readable, which is the only digital property the base records of them. No refugee population figure, and no statement of refugee access to any other digital public service, is held.	MOVEMENT
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A second community innovation hub opened in August 2026, against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment. The second hub opened in a rural region (hub, phase). It opened against a stated 58 per cent internet-usage rate and 56 per cent youth unemployment, and the account is the funding agency's own (opening). No financing figure was disclosed for the facility, and no user, training or enterprise-support count is published for either hub (hubs). Two hubs are the country's whole physical inclusion programme.	MOVEMENT

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics	The international statistics partnership's January 2026 table records the strategy as Designing, with no title or period against the country's name. The table gives a strategy title and period for most countries in the region and records Eswatini as Designing with neither (table). The statute beneath it is the Statistics Act of 1967, unamended on this base (Act). Capacity is being built in pieces rather than by strategy: a food-balance-sheet training in November 2025 established a national technical working group under the statistics office to regional standards (training). The largest statistical operation of the decade, the 2027 census, is funded at E130.5 million and under way without a strategy behind it.	NO CHANGE recorded as Designing while neighbours are implementing
National statistics	Censuses and surveys	A consumer financial survey launched its 2026 round, replacing a 2018 measurement, and a communications sector study was tendered at about E2.8m. The survey round was launched in July 2026, replacing a measurement eight years old (survey). The sector study tender was awarded in January 2026 (study). Both are commissioned measurements rather than recurring statistical series, and both are being stood up to replace figures the country has been reading from foreign reference studies – which is what the account-ownership and cash-share cells in this report rest on.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data	Civil registration produces the annual vital statistics report, and community health workers now capture records digitally in real time. The annual vital statistics report compiles administrative records from the population register and health systems into official vital statistics (report), and completeness reached 61 per cent of births and 62 per cent of deaths in 2025. The community-based health information system launched in September 2025 moved rural health motivators from paper to offline-capable real-time digital capture, linking community records to the national health systems (launch). The proposed national exchange platform is aimed at the fragmentation across government systems that keeps administrative data from being reused (proposal). The regularly published administrative series is vital statistics and nothing else: no administrative-source statistics are published for education, tax, land or social protection.	MOVEMENT
Open data	Use of open data	No open data portal exists. The digital readiness assessment records the absence, and the draft data governance policy is about sharing between institutions. The assessment places the country at the systematic stage across all six pillars and records no centralised open-data portal (assessment). The national data policy drafting opened in April 2026 with European Union, member state and German development-agency support (workshop), and the draft policy validated in July turns on institutions reaching each other's records rather than publishing them (validation). Where data is published it is published as documents: the 2025 civil registration report was launched publicly with national figures (commemoration). A report is not a dataset. No published dataset, licence or release obligation is held.	NO CHANGE no portal and a policy in draft that is about sharing rather than publishing

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data	The agriculture ministry runs a composite drought index on satellite inputs, and a space agency was announced in February 2026. The ministry's crop assessment runs a national composite drought index on satellite rainfall, vegetation-index and land-surface-temperature inputs; the 2021/22 assessment put maize production at 127,315 tonnes, 27 per cent up on the previous season, at an average national yield of 1.7 tonnes a hectare (assessment). An inaugural space science indaba convened by the ICT ministry in February 2026 to work the country's allocated orbital slot named agriculture, drought prediction and crop planning among the priority applications, and announced a national space agency (indaba). The index is four years old on this base and no later assessment using it is held; the agency has no instrument, budget or establishment date.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data	Ten automated weather stations and upgraded forecasting infrastructure were handed over in July 2026, on a statute from 1992. The National Meteorological Service Act of 1992 establishes the service and its data collection and dissemination mandate, and is unamended on the base (Act). An Italy-funded project handed over ten automated weather stations, eight river-flow gauges and upgraded forecasting and climate-modelling infrastructure in July 2026, delivered with United Nations development support (handover). The disaster management agency and the meteorological service ran a five-day workshop in June 2026 producing multi-hazard impact tables, a national impact-based risk matrix, standardised warning templates and a colour-coded alert system (workshop). The satellite half of it is inferred rather than stated: no source on this base describes the service's own use of satellite imagery, as distinct from ground stations and modelling.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A hyperscaler memorandum was confirmed by the attorney-general to have followed Cabinet and legal consultation, and a specimen sharing agreement entered into force in January 2026. The attorney-general confirmed that Cabinet approval and legal consultation preceded signature (confirmation, partnership), and the country was represented at the vendor's continental summit with its citizen application showcased (summit, partners). The specimen sharing agreement was signed in December 2025 and entered into force on 11 January 2026. The memorandum it hangs on is not published: main texts were posted for several countries and removed, and for this country only the agreement remains posted (agreement). So the hyperscaler arrangement was contested in public and its approval route confirmed, while the health arrangement's governing memorandum was published and then withdrawn.	MOVEMENT
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	The third partnership dialogue in May 2026 brought digital and science policy into the formal agenda; no financing figure for digital work is held. The dialogue was co-chaired by the European Union ambassador and the foreign minister under the successor partnership agreement, and discussed cooperation under the Union's investment strategy and its education and research programmes (dialogue). Separately the Union, its member states and the German development agency support the drafting of the national data policy under a data governance initiative for Africa (support). That drafting support is the one concrete European contribution to a digital instrument the base records. No named financing instrument, commitment amount or programme document covering digital work is held at any date.	MOVEMENT
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments	A women digital academy was launched virtually under a bilateral memorandum signed at a United Nations General Assembly. The academy launched in July 2026 under a memorandum signed at the 2025 General Assembly (academy). No cohort size, curriculum, funding or duration is published. It is the only delivered output of any Gulf arrangement in this ledger; the other, on power for the national data centre, remains an unsigned discussion.	MOVEMENT
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	A US\$10.4 million India Exim Bank line of credit for the data centre's disaster recovery site is the only Indian instrument on the base. The line of credit was signed in 2021 for construction of a disaster recovery site for the national data centre under the science park's second phase (line of credit). Five years on the site is not recorded as operating, and the communications regulator was tendering consultancy for a disaster recovery facility in October 2025 (tender). No disbursement figure, completion record or later Indian instrument is held. It is the base's clearest case of a bilateral commitment whose delivery cannot be traced.	NO CHANGE one line of credit from 2021 and nothing since

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Compute or high-performance computing capacity	A capacity disclosure for the National Data Centre - rack count, megawatts, uptime tier or utilisation - or a separate compute facility specification.	2026-08-09
Open government data portal	A national open-data portal, the published National Data Governance Policy text, or an access-to-information instrument.	2026-08-09
National AI strategy	A national AI strategy or statute, or a ministerial statement giving its drafting stage and expected adoption date.	2026-08-09
Chinese digital investment in Eswatini	Any Chinese financing, contract or memorandum covering Eswatini digital infrastructure.	2026-08-09
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or an Eswatini government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

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